ACTIVITY - 5

Your friend's family loves to eat boiled rice and dhal. Rice has to be boiled with lots of water and the extra water is thrown away.

- Is this way of wasting water right or wrong? Explain why?
- How can this problem be solved?

5. Poaching:

This involves cooking in minimum amount of liquid at temperatures of 80°C – 85°C that is below the boiling point. Foods generally poached are egg, fish and fruits. For poaching eggs, the addition of little salt or vinegar to the cooking liquid lowers temperature of coagulation. Eggs get cooked quickly by poaching.



Advantages

- A variety of liquids can be used (stock, wine, milk, syrup).
- Liquid can improve flavor.
- Food becomes more digestible.
- Ideal for high-protein foods, eg. fish

Disadvantages

- Requires constant attention.
- Range of suitable foods is limited.
- Food overcook quickly.

6. Blanching:

In meal preparation, it is often necessary only to peel off the skin of fruits and vegetables without making them tender. This can be achieved by blanching. eg. tomatoes can be blanched in this method, food is dipped in boiling water for 5 seconds to 2 minutes depending on the texture of the food. This helps to remove the skin or peel without softening the food.



Advantages

- Peels can easily be removed to improve digestibility.
- Destroys enzymes that bring about spoilage.
- Texture can be maintained while improving the colour and flavour of food.

Disadvantage

- Loss of nutrients if cooking water is discarded.

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